

7-0 (A)

RARE BIRD REPORT--SIGHT RECORD

REPORT FILED BY: Alan E. Versaw
403 Maplewood Drive
Colorado Springs, CO 80907
(719)266-5065

Recd 10/10/00 wpl

SPECIES: Prothonotary Warbler

DATE(S): 10/09/2000

OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: Male PLUMAGE: This time of year, the bird should be in fall plumage, but the bird I saw was a better match for "Variant (b)" on page 45 of the Dunn and Garrett book that the plate of the "fall adult male"

LAT/LONG: 19 ELEVATION: 6000 ft.

TIME OF DAY: 0930 LOCALITY: along Monument Creek bicycle trail in north Colorado Springs

NEAREST TOWN: in Colorado Springs city limits COUNTY: El Paso

DURATION OF OBSERVATION: 3-4 minutes

OTHER OBSERVERS: none

LIGHT CONDITIONS: cloudy bright, no direct sun

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT: Bushnell 8X42 Natureviews (no scope)

DISTANCE: 10 - 40 feet or more

PHOTO DATA: none

BIRD BEHAVIOR: The bird was mostly flying between and foraging among willows. The bird never got more than three or four feet above the ground and even lit on the ground two or three times. Loosely associated with other small birds in vicinity—Wilson's Warblers, Orange-crowned Warblers, and Ruby-crowned Kinglets.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF BIRD: Bright yellow head, nearly an orangish yellow on head and throat. Color faded to pale yellow by the legs and white in the undertail coverts. Back was a dark olive green; no markings on wings or folded tail. White patches on either side of the tail toward end of tail were visible on occasion when the bird would spread its tail just before landing. No notch in tail. Large dark eye. Grayish colored wings, clearly lighter than the color of the back. Warbler size and shape.

SONG AND/OR CALL: To the best of my knowledge, no call was given. Given the chips and rattles (RCKI) for surrounding birds, though, I could have missed a couple vocalizations.

HABITAT DESCRIPTION: Willow-lined bicycle path next to a fairly substantial, sandy-bottomed creek. Grasses and shrubs (oak, three-leaved sumac) a bit further back from the creek. Also, a few deciduous trees (chiefly cottonwoods) along course of creek, but the bird stayed to the willows during my observation.

ELIMINATION OF SIMILAR SPECIES: Yellow Warbler—no eye ring, silver-colored wings, olive-back, no streaking on chest, color of head too orangish, white undertail coverts. Blue-winged Warbler—no streak through eye, no wing bars.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILAR BIRDS: This was my life Prothonotary Warbler. Like everyone else in North American, I've seen a gazillion YWARs, but I have not previously seen a Blue-winged Warbler

REFERENCES CONSULTED: None in field. At home—Dunn and Garrett, Natl. Geo 3rd edition, Peterson's Western Birds 3rd edition

DATE OF REPORT: 10/9/2000

SIGNATURE: